

Solo Play

A step-by-step guide to Crisis Mode
in the Invincible Player app

Every die in the worked session was rolled by the app's own solo engines.

The random seed was chosen so the session exercises each mechanic; no individual result was edited.

Rules content paraphrased from the core rulebook; a personal play aid.

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If you read nothing else, read **§2 The loop** and **§13 Transitions at a glance**. Between them they contain the whole procedure.

1 • How to use this guide

Crisis Mode is the rulebook's solo mode: it replaces the Game Master with dice oracles and a set of timers. This guide walks the whole procedure in the order you actually play it, and shows the app's controls at each point. Every worked example follows one hero through one complete crisis, from the first alert to going home.

The dice in this guide are real. Each roll was made by the app's own solo engines while this document was generated, using the same code the app runs during play. Nothing was chosen to look tidy — where a roll went badly, the example carries on with the bad result.

BEFORE YOU START

- Turn on **Settings** → **Solo play (Crisis Mode)**. The **Play** tab then opens it.
- Build a hero on the **Home** tab if you have not already. Tick the solo box on the wizard's rank step so the allowance below is applied.
- Keep the **Action** tab handy — that is where fights are run when one starts.

The solo build allowance

A solo hero carries the whole story, so the chapter grants a little more:

- Create your hero normally, then add 2 extra attribute points.
- Start with one additional free talent. Durable, Resilience and Second Wind suit solo play.
- Favour powers that support utility and survivability (DUPLICATION, HEALING, QUICKNESS) over powers that mainly aid allies or need GM interpretation (ACTION PLAN, PRECOGNITION).
- Any rank works as long as you generate matching crisis alerts. Global Guardian is recommended.
- Instead of end-of-session karma, solo heroes earn karma by completing objectives on the objective timer.

The app applies the extra points and the extra free talent automatically once the solo box is ticked on the rank step.

2 • The loop

Solo play is a six-step loop. The Solo screen prints it as a numbered strip and highlights the step you are on; the card at the top of the screen always names the single next action.

Step	What it is	The app control
1	Generate a crisis alert from the random threat tables or the Complex Response Engine.	Generate crisis alert
2	Start the crisis level at 0 and begin making event checks.	Event check
3	Choose a crisis and start a crisis timer, plus any ally, objective or encounter timers.	Engage , on the Crises card
4	Make checks, track timers and the crisis level, and engage threats or opportunities.	Say what your hero just did
5	After resolving an event, threat or objective, play a social scene — especially to recover. Resolve.	Social scene
6	Return to any remaining crisis dangers, or head home to rest, recover and earn karma.	Head home

THE ONE RULE THAT KEEPS THE LOOP MOVING

Always have at least one timer running. A timer is what makes the situation change while you are busy — it is the pressure a GM would otherwise apply. If every timer is stopped, nothing is pushing back and play stalls.

Crisis level

A single 0–10 counter for how bad things have got. It rises when event checks fire and when a crisis timer runs out. It feeds back into the dice: a higher level makes crisis events harsher and objectives harder.

Level	Phase	Effect on objective checks
0–3	Low danger	No penalty
4–7	Medium danger	–1 progress die
8–10	High danger	–2 progress dice

3 • Steps 1 and 2 — the alert, then the heartbeat

Step 1 • Generate a crisis alert

A crisis alert works like a briefing: a priority message from an agency, a breaking news story, or something your hero witnesses on patrol.

Press **Generate crisis alert**. The app rolls the threat tables that suit your rank and lays the result out as four separate facts — kind, what is happening, where, and a complication. It also seeds the first entry on the **Crisis** card and resets the crisis level to 0.

IF YOU WANT THE PLACE DESCRIBED

The alert dialog offers the five location engines — City, Region, Space, Atmosphere, Facility. Roll one when you need to know what somewhere is actually like. The Atmosphere engine is blended into the others automatically so a place gets a mood as well as a shape.

Step 2 • Event checks

An event check is the heartbeat of the crisis: 2D6, rolled whenever time passes or you want to know whether the situation turns. It is the main way new trouble arrives.

2D6	Result
2	Roll for two crisis events; crisis level +2.
3–4	Roll for one crisis event; crisis level +1.
5–10	No event.
11–12	Opportunity event.

A crisis event is rolled on the **Crisis Event Engine**: D66 picks one of 36 focuses, then 2D6 plus the current crisis level picks the severity band (2-10 / 11-15 / 16+). Because the level is added, an escalating crisis produces harsher events by itself.

THE SESSION SO FAR

Backdraft — a Global Guardian — answers an alert at the docks: a reactor casualty aboard a berthed freighter. Crisis level 0. First event check:

2D6 → **4**. Roll for one crisis event; crisis level +1.

The engine gives: **Environment: Minor environmental hazard** (Focus D66 31 · detail 2D6 + crisis level = 5 (2-10))

Crisis level is now **1**.

4 · Step 3 — choosing a crisis and starting timers

The **Crises** card lists everything you could engage: the alert seeded one, and every event check that fires adds more. **Engage** turns a crisis into a running crisis timer named after it. **Ignore** leaves it pending — ignoring a danger is a legitimate choice, and it will still be there later.

Then add whichever other timers the scene needs. There are four types and they are not interchangeable — each answers a different question, and each is checked at a different moment.

Timer	Question it answers	Check it when
Crisis	How long until this goes wrong?	Time passes — between scenes, on a delay, changing location, lingering. +1 die for anything lengthy, −1 for anything fast.
Objective	Am I getting what I came for?	A milestone happens — something meaningful for or against the goal. Never on a clock.
Ally	How is the group holding up?	They face a threat or try something dangerous. Off-screen, at least once every few hours of game time.
Encounter	Have they found me yet?	Only while exploring or evading somewhere a fight could break out — once per zone you move through or linger in.

YOU NEVER HAVE TO PICK A TIMER YOURSELF

Step 4's control is **Say what your hero just did**. Choose from six plain descriptions of what happened — moved somewhere, searched, hit a milestone, allies in danger, a fight ended, time jumped — and the app fires the right checks in the right order with the right modifiers. The table above is the rule it is applying, printed so you can follow along.

THE SESSION SO FAR

Backdraft engages the reactor crisis. It becomes a crisis timer: **The reactor floods the lower decks**, starting at **distant** because the crisis level is still low.

She also sets an objective — **Get the maintenance crew out** — at **Far off**: 2 progress dice, paying **4 karma** when reached.

Nothing rolls yet. Setting an objective is bookkeeping; it only advances on a milestone.

5 • The crisis timer

A ladder counting down to something specific happening. You name what it triggers when you start it, and that is what happens when it runs out.

Proximity	Threat dice
Remote	6
Distant	5
Approaching	4
Soon	3
Looming	2
Imminent	1
Now	0

Where a new timer starts is either your choice or a roll: **2D6**, read against the column for the crisis phase you are in. A high crisis can never start Remote; only medium and high can start Imminent.

Proximity	Low 2D6	Medium 2D6	High 2D6	Threat dice
Remote	2-4	2-3	—	6
Distant	5-6	4-5	2-3	5
Approaching	7-8	6-7	4-6	4
Soon	9-10	8-9	7-8	3
Looming	11-12	10-11	9-10	2
Imminent	—	12	11-12	1

Roll its threat dice when time passes; **every 6 moves it one rung closer**. Reaching **now** fires the event, raises the crisis level by 1, and removes that timer — so start another.

Movement mode

How carefully you are moving shifts both the crisis timer and the encounter timer. Set it in the Crisis Mode header.

Mode	Crisis dice	Enemy dice	Your INTUITION	Their INTUITION
Alert (default)	0	0	0	0
Cautious	+1	-1	+1	-1
Rushed	-1	+1	-1	+1

Cautious buys safety with time: fewer enemy dice and sharper senses, but crisis timers advance faster. Rushed is the reverse.

THE SESSION SO FAR

Backdraft moves into the flooded deck. Crisis timer, 5 threat dice:

1	6	6	2	4
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 — **2 sixes**.

Distant → **Soon**.

6 • The objective timer

Your goal, and in solo play your **only source of karma** — the ten end-of-session questions do not apply. Name the objective, give it a starting distance, and it pays out when reached.

Status	Progress dice	Karma if reached
Out of reach	1	6
Far off	2	4
Manageable	3	2
Near	4	1
Within reach	5	—
Achievable	6	—
Objective reached	—	—

Something further away is slower but pays more. Roll its dice only on a **milestone** — a development that genuinely moved the goal, for or against. Never on a timer.

THE ARITHMETIC

- Each **6** advances one step; each **1** cancels a 6.
- A net **negative** result pushes the objective one step **back**, and overcoming that setback becomes your next milestone.
- A medium crisis costs **−1** die, a high crisis **−2**.

THE SESSION SO FAR

She finds the maintenance crew — a genuine milestone. Objective check, 2 progress dice:

2	6
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1 six − 0 ones = **1**. Advanced to Manageable.

7 • The encounter timer

Tracks how close the opposition is getting. **Only start one when it applies:** your hero is moving through or searching somewhere they could be found, and it is uncertain whether they have been. A fixed scene you already understand — holding up a collapsing floor, talking someone down, fighting what is already in front of you — needs no encounter timer at all.

The Encounter panel has a **Do I need one right now?** check that asks exactly that question.

Enemy presence	Enemy dice
All clear	1
Uncertain	2
Suspected	3
Confirmed	4
Closing	5
Near	6
Encountered	0

Check it once per zone you move through or linger in. Each 6 shifts the presence one rung. At **Encountered**, two things are read off the same roll:

Highest die	Enemy behaviour
6	Stalking, hidden or lying in wait — The NPCs automatically spot you; roll INTUITION to spot them.
5	Searching or hunting — You automatically spot them; they roll INTUITION to spot you.
4	Passive — You automatically spot them; they are unaware.
3	False alarm — Non-hostile NPCs, or unfounded paranoia.
2	False alarm — Non-hostile NPCs, or unfounded paranoia.
no 6s	Ambushing — Draw initiative — you are surprised.

Number of 6s	Threat size
1	Lesser foe — Lone soldier, guard, cultist, thug, hostile animal.
2	Greater enemy or group — Squad of soldiers, killer robot, infiltrators, an organization's enforcer.
3+	Overwhelming enemy — Parasite swarm, supervillain, kaiju, a Viltrumite.

THE SESSION SO FAR

Backdraft sweeps the flooded deck for the crew. It is unknown ground and something aboard is moving, so she starts an encounter timer at **All clear** and checks once per zone.

Zone 1 — 1 enemy die: 5 → presence **All clear**.

Zone 2 — 1 enemy die: 6 → presence **Uncertain**. Imprecise power effects, vague sounds of movement, tracks, signs someone passed this way.

Zone 3 — 2 enemy dice: 1 1 → presence **Uncertain**.

Zone 4 — 2 enemy dice: 1 3 → presence **Uncertain**.

Searching is a lengthy action, so the crisis timer rolls at +1 die: 4 dice, 6 1 4 6 → **Imminent**.

Avoiding a fight

- Hide: decide whether the enemy actively searches (ask the Binary Engine). If they search, roll INTUITION for them; if they don't search or fail, they move out of the zone within minutes.

- Back out: you can retreat from the zone without risk, but consider what that costs you in the location.
- Sneak past: roll INTUITION for the enemy; on a failure you slip through to the next zone.

Escaping one

Escape is an AGILITY roll. The modifiers:

Situation	Dice
You are using a movement power well suited to the environment	+1
You are outnumbered	-1
Fast movement is hampered by flooding, debris or similar	-1
You are escaping a speedy enemy such as a Viltrumite	-2
Hostile environment such as fires or extreme cold	-2

The twelve-step encounter sequence

The app walks this for you — the Encounter panel shows which step you are on and offers only that step's controls. It is printed here so you can see where you are in the procedure.

1. Choose your movement mode: alert, cautious or rushed.
2. Make an encounter check with enemy dice for the current presence, modified by movement mode.
3. Each 6 shifts the enemy presence one step closer.
4. If the presence isn't 'encountered' yet, continue moving.
5. On 'encountered', check the enemy behaviour table for who spots whom.
6. Check the enemy threat table (or established facts) for what you're facing.
7. Make spotting rolls as needed. An unspotted side may reveal itself, ambush, back out or hide.
8. If spotted but not surprised, you may attempt to escape with an AGILITY roll.
9. If the encounter isn't avoided or escaped, draw initiative.
10. Once resolved, reset the encounter timer.
11. Check any active crisis timers, modified by movement mode and prolonged actions.
12. Repeat as you move on or linger.

8 • The ally timer

A group helping you, tracked as one unit rather than as individual NPCs — a squad, a dock crew, a handful of other heroes. It measures how they are holding up.

Status	Support dice
Unified	6
Strained	5
Diminished	4
Overwhelmed	3
Desperate	2
Last Stand	1
You are Alone	0

READING AN ALLY CHECK

- Each **6** is a success. In a fight each 6 is also **2 damage** to the enemy.
- Each **1** drops their status one step, toward Alone.
- **+2** dice if the task suits them, **+3** if the situation strongly favours them.
- Allies aiding you directly instead give **+2 dice** to your own roll.

THE SESSION SO FAR

The dock crew hold the bulkhead while Backdraft works — suited to them, so +2 dice. 8 dice:

2

3

5

4

3

4

1

3

No successes. 1 setback(s): now Strained. They are now **Strained**.

9 • The oracles

Everything that answers a question a GM would otherwise answer. They live on the **Ask the oracles** card.

Yes / no — the Binary Response Engine

D6	Answer
1	Strong no
2–3	No
4–5	Yes
6	Strong yes

If a yes is likely, roll 2D6 and keep the **highest**; if a no is likely, keep the **lowest**. A strong result is unequivocal and hands you something extra besides.

Complex answers

Two D66 rolls give a directive and a subject — for example **Abandon / Authority**, which might mean the officer in charge walks off the job. Take it literally, interpret it, or roll again.

Describe a place

Five location engines, rolled when you arrive somewhere and need to know what it is like:

- **City Engine** — Where in the city you are, or need to travel to.
- **Region Engine** — Outdoor locations and larger regions.
- **Space Engine** — Outer space and interstellar travel.
- **Facility Engine** — Interiors of buildings, complexes, bases, lairs and factories.
- **Atmosphere Engine** — A descriptive prompt for an area — mundane detail, mystery or obstacle.

Crisis event — the jolt

If you are ever unsure what happens next: raise the crisis level by 1 and roll a crisis event. That is the book's own advice, and the app has a button for it.

Opportunity events

The positive counterpart, prompted by 11–12 on an event check. Keep them rare. One may itself count as a milestone that triggers an objective check.

D66	Opportunity
11–16	Early warning of a danger
21–26	Helpful item or technology
31–36	Needed clue or intel
41–43	Secure location
44–46	Shortcut or safer path
51–53	Significant device or artifact
54–56	Timely communication
61–63	Unexpected ally
64–66	Useful supplies or support

Bonus 6 effects

When an **attribute** roll comes up with more 6s than it needed, one spare 6 can buy one of these. This applies to attribute rolls only — not to threat, progress, support or enemy dice.

Effect	What it does
Confident	Regain 1 point of Resolve.
Fast	You act faster than expected. Crisis timer checks this scene roll -1 threat die.
Impressive	You impress onlookers: +1 die to PRESENCE rolls in this scene.
Intimidating	Enemies falter: -1 die to attribute rolls and attacks made against you this scene.
Observant	You notice an important detail: +1 die on your next roll acting on it.
Masterful	+1 die on your next attribute roll.
Unnoticed	You act with subtlety: encounter checks and NPC INTUITION rolls take -1 die.

THE SESSION SO FAR

Second event check: 2D6 → **8**. No event.

Separately, a FATE response points at a positive turn — the book's other trigger for an opportunity: D66 55 — **Timely communication**.

Later, unsure what the freighter's crew do next, Backdraft takes the jolt: crisis level +1, then the Crisis Event Engine. Focus D66 **61** — **Supernatural**. Detail 2D6 + crisis level = **4**, band 2-10: **Mysterious sighting**.

10 • Combat

A FIGHT STARTS IN EXACTLY THREE WAYS

1. An **encounter timer** reaches Encountered and you neither avoid nor escape it. The Encounter panel walks you to **Draw initiative**.
2. You **choose to attack** something the fiction has already put in front of you — start an action scene on the Action screen.
3. A **crisis timer fires into a fight**, because that is what you named it as triggering.

Combat itself is the ordinary combat system — the Action screen runs it. Initiative is a card 1–10 per combatant per round, lowest first. On your turn you have one full action plus one quick action, or two quick actions.

The app deals the cards, marks whose turn it is, and gates attacking on turn order. Attacking spends your full action and ends your turn, and the marker moves to the next card automatically.

Running the enemy without a GM

The encounter roll already told you two things: **behaviour** (from the highest die) and **threat size** (from the number of 6s). Use behaviour to decide what they do on their turn, and ask the Binary Engine when it is genuinely unclear. Pull the actual stat block from the **NPCs** tab.

Powers without a GM

- With a relevant power such as DETECTION, ENHANCED SENSES or TELEPATHY, an encounter check that rolls at least one 6 and no more than one 1 without triggering an encounter lets you choose one option instead of rolling the next check.
- Outmaneuver: if the presence is closing or worse, shift it one rank further away as you move to an adjacent zone.
- Prepare: if the presence is closing or near, shift straight to encountered and ignore the behaviour table — you automatically spot them and they must roll INTUITION to spot you.

Solo combat and recovery

- Draw initiative as normal for your hero and any NPCs; a single card covers an NPC group.
- Roll for NPC actions as a GM would when they act against or aid your hero. Some push rolls and take stress for exploits; many won't.
- Choose the most sensible NPC action for the circumstances. If unsure, ask the Binary Engine.
- When an NPC does something that doesn't directly affect your hero, just decide whether it works — unless it's dramatic and dangerous.

- Most sentient NPCs value self-preservation: when things go badly they defend or flee. Check their willingness with the Binary Engine.
- When an NPC is broken you need not roll a critical injury — declare them knocked out or killed as fits the moment.
- **If you are broken by damage or stress you can still act, at -1 die.**
- **When broken by stress you may make a PRESENCE roll as if aided by an ally — but the aid is an important memory. Decide what comforts or inspires you in that moment.**

The app shows the recovery panel exactly when it applies, including a **Rally on a memory** roll at PRESENCE with a help die.

11 • Step 5 — the social scene

After you resolve an event, a threat or an objective, play a social scene. Mechanically it restores **Resolve equal to your PRESENCE rating** — and Resolve does not come back from resting, so this is the only way to get it.

- Condense a social scene into a brief statement rather than roleplaying a conversation with yourself.
- Alternatively, frame it as a flashback relevant to the current crisis.
- The social hooks table works as inspiration.

The app's **Social scene** button applies the recovery, prints that guidance and offers a social-hooks roll for a prompt. It also clears the "social scene due" state, so the loop moves on.

WHEN IT IS DUE

The Solo screen tracks this for you: resolving a crisis, completing an objective, or a timer firing all mark a social scene as due, and the next-step card will say so. Playing one through the ordinary session lifecycle counts too.

12 • Step 6 — ending the crisis

Resolve crisis

When the danger is dealt with, press **Resolve crisis**. It shows exactly what it will do first — clear the alert, drop pending crises, stop the running timers, reset the crisis level, queue a social scene — and it is undoable in one step.

Head home

With nothing left running and nothing waiting, **Head home** closes the session:

- A few hours' rest: **all Health and all Resolve** return.
- Every **reached objective** pays its karma. This is where solo karma is actually banked.
- Karma spending unlocks — it is spent between sessions, in a safe location, and home counts.
- The board clears, ready for the next alert.

KARMA IN SOLO PLAY

Solo heroes do not answer the ten earn / six bad-karma session questions — objectives replace them. With Crisis Mode on, the app's End session dialog suppresses those questions and points you back here, so the two paths can never double-count.

THE SESSION SO FAR

With the crew located, Backdraft makes the final push on the objective. Crisis level is now **2**. 3 dice:

5	2	2
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0 sixes – 0 ones = **0**. No progress — consider why this milestone didn't help, or what minor complication appeared.

Crisis level ended at **2** — Low danger. Resolve the crisis, play the social scene, then head home and bank the karma.

13 • Common mistakes

Mistake	Why it breaks play	Do this instead
Letting every timer stop	Nothing is pushing back, so the story stalls and you end up inventing pressure by hand.	Keep at least one crisis timer running at all times. When one fires, start another.
Rolling the objective on a clock	Objectives are not timers. Rolling them as time passes makes karma automatic and drains the tension.	Roll it only on a milestone — something that genuinely moved the goal, for or against.
Starting an encounter timer for every scene	Fixed, known scenes have nothing to discover, so the check is noise.	Only while exploring or evading. Use the panel's Do I need one right now? check.
Taking bonus 6 effects on timer rolls	They are scoped to attribute rolls. Threat, progress, support and enemy dice are not attribute rolls.	Only on attribute rolls — and the app only offers them there.
Answering the session karma questions	Solo karma comes from objectives; answering both double-counts it.	Bank karma by reaching objectives and heading home. The app suppresses the questions in solo mode.
Overriding an oracle you dislike	The oracles are the GM. Ignoring them makes you the GM again, and the surprise goes.	Take the answer and make it fit. If it truly cannot fit, read adjacent rows rather than re-rolling.

Appendix A • Crisis Event Engine

D66 for the focus, then 2D6 + the current crisis level for the detail. If the event does not fit your situation, read the adjacent rows for inspiration, or choose a focus deliberately and roll only the detail.

D66	Focus	2-10	11-15	16+
11	Adversary	Adversary revealed	Adversary gains an advantage	Adversary seizes an objective
12	Alert	Under surveillance	Security protocols activated	Blaring alarms
13	Alien	Reported abductions	First contact	Major presence
14	Ally	Ally in danger	Separated from each other	True identity or motive revealed
15	City	Crime witnessed	Structural instability	Panic in the streets
16	Command	New orders	Incompetent leaders	Left for dead
21	Communication	Distress signal	Desperate plea	Comms go quiet
22	Community	Isolated community	Threatened habitat	Abandoned or destroyed
23	Contamination	Signs of contamination	Quarantined	Sudden outbreak
24	Corporation	Scheming influence	Company takes control	True motivation revealed
25	Creatures	Lone creature	Creature group	Swarming creatures
26	Dimension	Extradimensional visitor	Portal opened	Full-scale invasion
31	Environment	Minor environmental hazard	Hostile environment	Environmental disaster
32	Fear	Fears kindled	Fear overrides logic	Widespread hysteria
33	Gear	Depleted or malfunctioning item	Lost or broken equipment	Vital gear lost or broken
34	Heroes	Strange disappearances	Casualties	Wiped out
35	Information	Troubling intel	False leads	Distressing revelation
36	Isolation	Cut off	Left behind	Outnumbered
41	Machine	Minor malfunction	Dangerous malfunction	Total failure
42	Magic	Amateur in over their head	Dangerous occult ritual	Magical devastation
43	Military	Minor military presence	Major intervention	Scorched earth
44	Mission	Minor complication	Major complication	Mission undone
45	Mutation	Parasitic infestation	Emerging lifeforms	Body remade
46	Organization	Antagonistic organization revealed	Organization exerts force or influence	Organizations at war
51	Power	Power fluctuations	Power fails	Reactor meltdown
52	Robot	Malfunctioning or damaged	Twitchy	Corrupted or destructive
53	Route	Treacherous route	Blocked or sealed route	Deadly route
54	Science	Unexplained phenomenon	Dangerous experiment	Containment breach
55	Sound	Mysterious sound	Unsettling sound	Horrifying sound
56	Space	Oppressive void	Collision course	Celestial catastrophe
61	Supernatural	Mysterious sighting	Paranormal activity	Otherworldly incursion
62	Supervillain	Supervillain's minions	Supervillain's enforcers	Supervillain showdown

D66	Focus	2-10	11-15	16+
63	Team	Squabbling teammates	Infighting	Betrayal or abandonment
64	Technology	Failing technology	Sabotaged technology	Rogue technology
65	Time	Wasted time	Impending deadline	Time runs out
66	Violence	Signs of violence	Grisly remains	Carnage

Appendix B • Complex Response Engine

Two D66 rolls: a directive and a subject. Read the pair literally, interpret it, or roll again.

D66	Directive
11	Abandon
12	Aid
13	Alert
14	Ambush
15	Attack
16	Betray
21	Breach
22	Capture
23	Command
24	Construct
25	Create
26	Deliver
31	Destroy
32	Discover
33	Escape
34	Escort
35	Explore
36	Heal
41	Hide
42	Hunt
43	Infest
44	Investigate
45	Isolate
46	Preserve
51	Protect
52	Quarantine
53	Reclaim
54	Repair
55	Sabotage
56	Scavenge
61	Secure
62	Survive
63	Threaten

D66	Directive
64	Transform
65	Transport
66	Unearth

D66	Subject
11	Alarm
12	Alien
13	Artifact
14	Authority
15	Cargo
16	City
21	Computer
22	Containment
23	Corporation
24	Creature
25	Darkness
26	Data
31	Death
32	Destruction
33	Device
34	Environment
35	Experiment
36	Fear
41	Focus
42	Hostility
43	Injury
44	Machine
45	Message
46	Military
51	Mission
52	Outbreak
53	People
54	Planet
55	Robot
56	Ship
61	Space
62	Supplies
63	Time

D66	Subject
64	Trap
65	Violence
66	Weapon

13 • Transitions at a glance

The single hardest part of solo play is knowing when to move from one thing to the next. This is the whole answer on one page.

You just...	Roll this	Then
Generated an alert	Nothing	Event check (step 2)
Made an event check that fired	Crisis Event Engine	The event joins the Crises card — engage or ignore it
Engaged a crisis	Nothing	Play. Say what your hero did
Set an objective	Nothing	Play. It only moves on a milestone
Moved to a new place	Encounter check, then crisis timers	If Encountered: reveal, avoid, escape or fight
Searched, waited or worked	Encounter check, then crisis timers +1 die	Same
Hit a milestone	Objective check, then an event check	If reached, claim karma when you head home
Sent allies into danger	Ally check	Each 1 drops their status a step
Finished a fight or long scene	Crisis timers +1 die , then an event check	Social scene if something resolved
Had a crisis timer fire	Nothing further	Deal with it, start another timer, social scene
Resolved the crisis	Nothing	Social scene, then head home

Deciding whether you need an encounter timer

Ask one question: **is my hero moving through or searching somewhere the opposition could find them?** Patrol, sweep of an unknown building, sneaking past a cordon, an escape — yes. A fixed, known scene — no, and the crisis timers and objective carry on regardless.

If you are stuck

1. Check the next-step card at the top of the Solo screen. It always names one action.
2. If the fiction has stalled rather than the procedure, take the jolt: crisis level +1 and roll a crisis event.
3. If a specific question is blocking you, ask the Binary Engine and accept the answer.

Appendix C • One-page play aid

The loop

1. Generate a crisis alert from the random threat tables or the Complex Response Engine.
2. Start the crisis level at 0 and begin making event checks.
3. Choose a crisis and start a crisis timer, plus any ally, objective or encounter timers.
4. Make checks, track timers and the crisis level, and engage threats or opportunities.
5. After resolving an event, threat or objective, play a social scene — especially to recover Resolve.
6. Return to any remaining crisis dangers, or head home to rest, recover and earn karma.

Timer triggers

Timer	Check it when
Crisis	Time passes. +1 die lengthy, -1 fast. Each 6 moves it closer; at now it fires and the level rises.
Objective	A milestone. 6s advance, 1s cancel 6s, net-negative pushes it back. Medium -1 die, high -2.
Ally	They face danger. Each 6 a success (2 damage in a fight), each 1 drops a step.
Encounter	Per zone while exploring or evading only. Each 6 shifts presence.

Event check — 2D6

Roll	Result
2	Roll for two crisis events; crisis level +2.
3–4	Roll for one crisis event; crisis level +1.
5–10	No event.
11–12	Opportunity event.

Binary — D6

Roll	Answer
1	Strong no
2–3	No
4–5	Yes
6	Strong yes

Likely yes: 2D6 keep highest. Likely no: keep lowest.

Stuck?

Crisis level +1, roll a crisis event. That is the book's own answer.

Appendix D • Glossary

Term	Meaning
Crisis alert	The briefing that opens a crisis — rolled from the threat tables for your rank.
Crisis level	0–10 counter for how bad things are. Feeds crisis-event severity and objective penalties.
Crisis event	A new or worsening complication, rolled on the Crisis Event Engine. Raises the level by 1.
Opportunity event	The positive counterpart. Rare. May count as a milestone.
Milestone	Something that genuinely moved your objective, for or against. The only trigger for an objective check.
Proximity	Which rung a crisis timer is on, from distant to now.
Presence	Which rung an encounter timer is on, from All clear to Encountered.
Movement mode	Alert, cautious or rushed. Shifts crisis and encounter dice in opposite directions.
Stressed out	Resolve 0. You act normally but cannot push and cannot spend stress on powers.
Broken	Health 0. In solo play you can still act, at –1 die.